First aid

First aid represents the set of simple and quick measures provided to a person who is injured or in danger, until the medical teams arrive. It can make the difference between life and death, especially in emergency situations. Anyone can provide first aid if they know a few basic rules and act calmly.

General principles

When providing first aid, it is important to follow a few essential principles. First of all, we must make sure that the location is safe both for us and for the victim. We should not intervene if there are additional dangers.

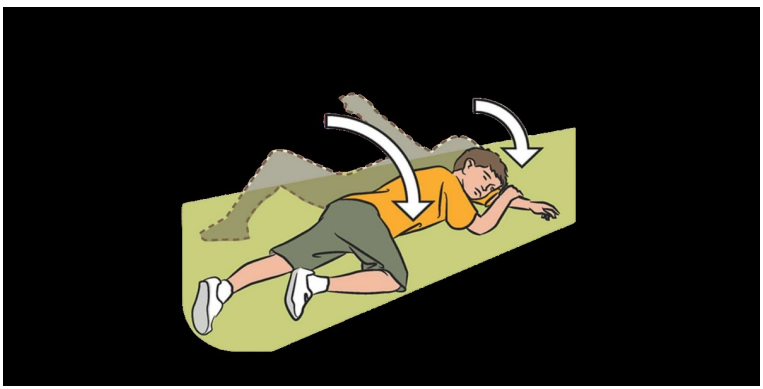
Then, the person's condition must be assessed quickly: whether they are conscious, whether they are breathing and whether they have visible injuries. At the same time, the emergency service (112) must be called, providing clear information about the situation.

Checking the victim's condition

The first step is checking consciousness. If the person responds to questions or reacts, it means that they are conscious. If they do not respond, breathing must be checked. Breathing is checked by observing the movements of the chest or by placing the ear close to the mouth and nose. If the person is not breathing, immediate intervention is required.

The recovery position

If the victim is unconscious but is breathing, they must be placed in the recovery position. This position prevents choking and keeps the airways open. It is important for the person to be placed on their side, with the head tilted slightly.



Recovery position: the person is placed on their side, with the head tilted slightly to keep the airways open.

Resuscitation (CPR)

If the person is not breathing, cardiopulmonary resuscitation (CPR) must be started. This consists of rhythmic chest compressions, applied to the centre of the chest.

The compressions must be performed firmly and steadily, until specialised help arrives. If the person providing help is trained, rescue breaths can also be given.

Bleeding

In the case of bleeding, it is important to stop the loss of blood as quickly as possible. This is done by applying direct pressure to the wound, using a dressing or a piece of clean material.

If the bleeding is heavy, the affected limb can be slightly raised in order to reduce the blood flow.

Burns

In the case of burns, the affected area must be cooled immediately with cold water, for several minutes. Creams, oils or other substances must not be applied. Severe burns require quick medical intervention.

Fractures and contusions

If a fracture is suspected, the person should not be moved unnecessarily. The affected area must be immobilised, and the victim must be kept in a comfortable position until help arrives.